

JUSTIFICATION FOR BRAND NAME
(Simplified Procedures - MPT to ≤ SAT)

Purchase Request/Document number: 1301349912

The supplies or services described herein are being solicited on a brand name basis and competition is precluded in accordance with FAR 12.102(a) for reasons indicated below. There are no substitutes available for the supplies or services.

Restricted to the following source.

☐ **Service:**

Contractor:	
Cage Code:	

☒ **Supply:**

Original Manufacturer Name:	Sidero Labs
☒ Check here if obtaining product through authorized resellers of the manufacturer.	

Description of the supplies or services required, the estimated price/cost, and required delivery date or period of performance.

The purpose of this procurement is to obtain 50 Nodes of Talos Linux FIPS Compliant Build and Included Enterprise Support (24/7) – Support for Talos and Kubernetes

Description	Quantity
Talos Linux FIPS Compliant Build	50 Nodes
Enterprise Support (24/7) - Support for Talos and Kubernetes	N/A
TOTAL	

In conclusion, the requested supplies or services represent the minimum requirements of the government.

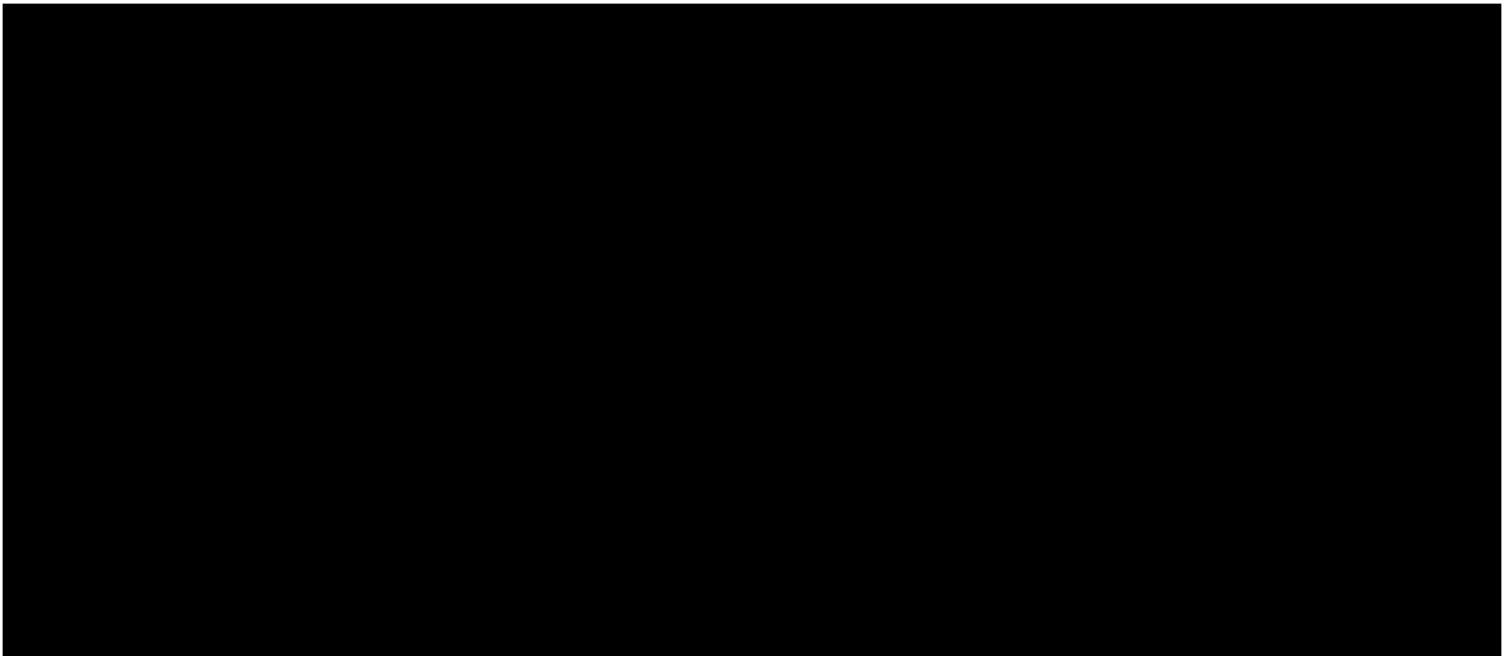
Describe in detail why only this source(s) can furnish the requirements to the exclusion of other sources.

☒ The supplies or services must be compatible in all aspects (form, fit and function) with existing systems presently installed/performing. Describe the equipment/function you have now and how the new item/service must coordinate, connect, or interface with the existing system.

Talos Linux is not a general-purpose operating system adapted for containers; it is an OS designed from the ground up exclusively for running Kubernetes. This specialization ensures optimal performance, security, and integration. The operating system is immutable, meaning it cannot be changed after deployment. This feature significantly enhances security by preventing configuration drift and unauthorized modifications, leading to a more stable and predictable environment. By being minimalistic and immutable, Talos Linux reduces the attack surface and provides a secure foundation for the Kubernetes clusters, a critical requirement for the command's

infrastructure. It includes only the necessary components to run Kubernetes, which simplifies deployment, reduces complexity, and makes management easier for the N61 staff. The version being procured is FIPS-140-2 compliant, a mandatory requirement for systems within the department.

The requested procurement for TalOS FIPS is a compliance-driven expenditure rather than a technical requirement for basic software functionality. While the underlying operating system can be deployed and operated independently, the purchase of this specific license is the mandatory vehicle for achieving FIPS 140-3 regulatory compliance, as dictated by DOD security policy and mandates. Included with this license is a comprehensive product support package, which mitigates operational risk by providing direct access to vendor expertise. In summary: the deployment is driven by mission needs, but this expenditure is strictly required to satisfy the legal and policy-driven security standards governing our environment.



I HEREBY DETERMINE THAT THE CIRCUMSTANCES JUSTIFYING BRAND NAME APPLIES TO THE CONTRACT ACTION.

MCCUNE.ALEXANDRIA
A.ELIZABETH
ANN.1548290992

Digitally signed by
MCCUNE.ALEXANDRIA.ELIZABETH
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Date: 2026.04.22 16:49:53 -04'00'

Contracting Officer Signature
Date

NAVSUP Fleet Logistics Center, Norfolk
Contracting Department – Fleet Directorate